

*****Dear Ron, If you find any problems or have comments/suggestions, please flag them and let us know. Please don't alter any wording. Thank you!*****

NSON#

Michigan DP T1 Questionnaire

Hello, my name is [fill NAME]. I'm calling from the [fill in]. We're conducting a survey for public broadcasting in Michigan of what people in Michigan think about Michigan's economy and its future. Your telephone number was selected at random.

Is this a private residence?

May I speak with the person 18 years or older in your household who most recently had a birthday? Is it you or someone else?

If R IS the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, skip to B. If R is NOT the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, please continue:

Could I speak with him/her?

If he or she is available, restart at A. If not available, please continue.

I would like to call back to speak with him/her, when do you think I could reach him/her?

- A. Hello, my name is [fill NAME]. I'm calling from the [fill in]. We're conducting a survey of what people in Michigan think about Michigan's economy and its future. Your telephone number was selected at random.
- B. It's very important to us to get a picture of what *all* people in Michigan think, so we hope you can spare a few minutes of your time, even if these are issues you haven't thought much about.

IF R agrees to participate:

Great! We're very interested in knowing what you think. If we get to a question where you don't have an opinion, just say so. All your answers will be kept completely confidential. If you have any questions regarding this study, you can contact [fill].

Again this is a survey about what the people of Michigan think about Michigan's economy and its future. If we come to a question you don't have much opinion about, just say so, and we'll move on to the next one.

- 1. To begin with, on a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "not at all a problem", 10 is "a big problem," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how big a problem would you say unemployment is in Michigan? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
- 2. On the same scale, how big a problem would you say poverty is in Michigan? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Policy items

Now here are some general questions about things the State Government should or shouldn't do.

- 3. Some people think that the State Government should decrease taxes even if this means less funding for programs like education, health care, and pensions. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that the State Government should spend more on programs like education, health care, and pensions even if this means increasing taxes. Suppose these people

are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place your views on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

4. Where would you place the Democratic Party on the same scale? Or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
5. Where would you place the Republican Party on the same scale? Or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
6. Some people think the State Government should do all it can to reduce unemployment. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think the State Government should just let a recovering economy take care of the problem. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place your views on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
7. Where would you place the Democratic Party on the same scale? Or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
8. Where would you place the Republican Party on the same scale? haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
9. Would you say the amount of money the State of Michigan is spending on assistance to poor people is much too much, somewhat too much, about right, somewhat too little, or much too little? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
10. Some people think that assistance to poor people should be focused on those who need it most. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that assistance to poor people should be focused on those who are trying to find work. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4. Where would you place your views on this scale? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
11. And, now, we'd like know how strongly you favor or oppose each of the following things the State Government could do to reduce poverty in Michigan. Here's the first:
 - a. Spending more on programs to create new jobs
favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
Or haven't you thought much about this?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
 - b. Spending more on job-training programs
favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
 - c. Spending more on public schools throughout the state

favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

d. Increasing the benefits paid by State programs to assist poor families
favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

12. Now, thinking about the future of Michigan, how strongly would you favor or oppose each of the following as things the State Government could focus on to improve the future of Michigan?

a. spending more to develop the tourism economy, as for example the North Coast

favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
Or haven't you thought much about this?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

b. developing a knowledge-based economy

favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

c. developing a green economy

favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

d. developing a manufacturing economy

favor strongly,
favor somewhat
neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

e. pushing initiatives that encourage employers to hire Michigan residents

favor strongly,
favor somewhat

neither favor nor oppose
oppose somewhat,
oppose strongly,
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

13. And, on a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "not responsible at all", 10 is "completely responsibility," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much responsibility does each of the following bear for Michigan's current economic problems?
- a. The Federal Government
 - b. The Michigan State Government
 - c. Big Michigan companies
 - d. Wall Street
 - e. Labour unions
 - f. Events beyond anyone's control
- IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Knowledge

Now we come to some factual questions to which not everyone may know the right answers. If we come to one to which you don't know the answer, don't worry about it. Just say so and we'll move on to the next one.

14. Do you happen to know which political party holds the majority in the Michigan State Senate, or couldn't you say about that? **(If yes, without naming party, or other)** Which party do you have in mind? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
15. How about the Michigan State House of Representatives? Do you happen to know which political party holds the majority there, or couldn't you say about that? **(If yes, without naming party, or other)** Which party do you have in mind? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
16. Which of the following states has unemployment rates similar to Michigan's?
- Oregon
 - West Virginia
 - Ohio
 - Louisiana
- Or, couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
17. People who have reached the 48-month limit can stay eligible for the Family Independence Program if...?
- they live in a county with a high unemployment rate
 - they were fired from a job while on the Family Self-Sufficiency Plan
 - they are non-citizens on the Refugee Assistance Program
 - they have a small child who is active in the ChildFirst® program
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
18. About what percentage of African American children in Michigan live in poverty?
- Under 20%
 - About 30%
 - About 40%
 - Over 50%
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Background

Finally, a few questions about you:

19. When you think of your economic situation today, do you think you are much better off than most, somewhat better off, about the same as most, somewhat worse off, or much worse off than most? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
20. On average how many of the last 7 days would you say you watch the news on TV? If you don't watch news on TV at all, just say 0.
21. On average, how many of the last 7 days did you read a daily newspaper? If you don't generally read a newspaper, just say 0.
22. On average, how many of the last 7 days did you read the news on the internet? If you don't generally read news on the internet, just say 0.
23. On average, how often would you say you talk with people about politics and public affairs, almost every day, several times a week, at least once a week, at least once a month, or practically never?
24. Generally speaking, how interested would you say you are in politics and public affairs in the U.S., very interested, somewhat interested, not very interested, or not at all interested?
25. Generally speaking, how interested would you say you are in politics and public affairs in Michigan, very interested, somewhat interested, not very interested, or not at all interested?
26. Which of the following best describes the highest level of education you have completed? [READ]
 - 01 Less than high school
 - 02 High school
 - 03 Some university / college
 - 04 University / college graduate
 - 05 Some graduate work
 - 06 Graduate degree
 - 07 Other (specify: _____)**VOLUNTEERED**
 - 97 Refused/No answer

27. In what year were you born? _____

28. And what is your current employment status? Are you currently ... :

READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—CODE ONE ONLY

- | | | |
|---|---|----------------|
| 1 | Employed full-time | CONTINUE |
| 2 | Employed part-time | CONTINUE |
| 3 | Not employed, but actively looking for work; or | CONTINUE |
| 4 | Student | SKIP Next 2 Qs |
| 5 | Not actively looking for work | SKIP Next 2 Qs |
| 6 | Refused | SKIP Next 2 Qs |

29. (If employed) On a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is impossible, 10 is certain-sure to happen, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how likely do you think it is that you lose your job...?..?

30. ~~(If employed) lose your job~~ _____ CONTINUE
31. ~~(If employed) On a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is no trouble at all, 10 is a great deal of trouble, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much trouble do you think you will have trouble-finding another job, if you lose your present job? if lose the one you have~~ _____ CONTINUE
32. _____
33. ~~(If not employed/seeking work) On a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is no trouble at all, 10 is a great deal of trouble, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much trouble do you think you will have finding a job?have trouble finding another job-~~
SKIP Next Q
34. (If employed) Which of the following best describes your employment?
- Self employed
 - Business under 25 employees
 - Business with 25 or more employees
 - Government
 - Other
35. (If employed) Have you been unemployed anytime in the past year?
36. ~~How about~~Has any other members of your household, ~~have any of them~~ been unemployed anytime in the past year?
37. How often would you say you attend religious services, every week, almost every week, once or twice a month, a few times a year, or never?
38. Are you currently married and living with your spouse? IF YES, SKIP Next Q.
39. **(If no)** Are you living with a partner?
40. How many children do you have under 18 living at home? If you don't have any, just say 0.
41. Which of the following broad income categories best describes your total household income before taxes in 2008? Would it be ... : **READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—CODE ONE ONLY**
- 1 Less than \$25,000
 - 2 Between \$25,000 and \$50,000
 - 3 Between \$50,000 and \$75,000
 - 4 Between \$75,000 and \$100,000, or
 - 5 Between \$100,000 and \$125,000
 - 6 Between \$125,000 and \$150,000
 - 7 More than \$150,000
 - 8 Refused/No answer
 - 9 Don't know
42. Which of the following racial or ethnic group would you say best describes you, White, Black, Native American, Asian/Pacific Islander, Hispanic/Latino or Other? **(If Other)** And, what is that?
43. Some people consider themselves extremely liberal. Suppose these people are at one end of a 0-to-10 scale, at point 0. Other people consider themselves extremely conservative. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 10. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 5, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 0 and 10. Where would you

place your views on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98;
IF NO OPINION, then 99.

44. And generally speaking, would say that you usually think of yourself as a Democrat, a Republican, an independent, or what? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

45. Gender [by observation]

- 1 Male
- 2 Female

That was the last question. Now I have a special invitation for you. The [fill] is sponsoring something called a Deliberative Poll of a random sample of people from Michigan all across the state. We are inviting people who have completed this interview to attend. Over the weekend of **November 13 to 15**, you will have a chance to discuss Michigan's present and future and to question policy experts and policy makers about it.

We can offer a **payment of \$225 for the weekend** as a token of appreciation for your time, and **meals and lodging will be provided**. Participants will stay at the Radisson Hotel Lansing. The event is carefully balanced, with all points of view represented and considered. We expect there to be a significant television and newspaper coverage. You would need to arrive by **6:00pm** for opening dinner on the 13th and would be free to leave by **4:30 p.m. on the 15th**. The event is being organized by [fill] at the [fill] and [fill].

The object is to see what ordinary people from Michigan like you would think about Michigan's economy and its future. The results will be shared with the [fill]. It's a chance to make your voice heard.

We'll provide some information about the options and the arguments for and against the issues being discussed. It's very important to us to get a picture of what *all* people in Michigan would think about these issues when they've had the chance of thinking, learning, and talking about them. Participants in past Deliberative Polls have found them extremely interesting and enjoyable. We hope that you will be able to take part in this exciting and important event.

We understand of course if you need some time to think about this opportunity, but I wonder if you could tell me if you would ...

Definitely be interested in attending this event

Possibly be interested in attending

Or definitely not be interested in attending.

IF DEFINITELY YES,

That's great!!! We're delighted to have you. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need. If you have any questions, you're most welcome to call [fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number). Could we get your address to mail you some materials for the event? Do you have an e-mail address?

IF POSSIBLY,

That's great!!! We're delighted you'll consider it. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need and see if you have any questions we can answer. We very much hope you'll attend. Do you have an address where we could send you some materials about the event? Do you have an e-mail address? In the meantime, if you have any questions, please feel free to call fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number).

IF NO,

Oh, that's too bad! I want to thank you for your time in responding to this interview. If you change your mind about participating in the weekend event on November 13-15 or if you have any questions about it, please feel free to call fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number).